

et les comptes ■ Des Comités de l'aide aux affamés! ■ Regarde, ■ Tu vois ■ Dernière ces années 1917 ■
nt ■ Fort et doux ■ Enveloppe dans la neige ■ Des milliers ■ De millions de toits, ■ La neige ■ Cercueil
Volga. ■ Les cheminées, ■ Les cierges. ■ Même les corbeaux ■ Disparaissent, ■ Ils sentent ■ Que, fumante,
ouce et nauséabonde, ■ L'odeur ■ Du fils, ■ Du père, ■ De la mère. ■ De la fille ■ Que l'on rôtit. ■ De qui e
■ Il n'y aura pas de secours, ■ Séparés par la neige, ■ Pas de sec
■ Même le mortier ■ On le dévore! Même les mauvaises herbes! ■
ovinces ■ Mesurez les tombes. ■ Vingt millions ■ Vingt, ■ Couchez
Avec de folles malédictions, ■ Les cheveux neigeux des chemins ■
peu de pain. ■ Encore du pain! ■ Elle même, voyant la mort en fa
a ville tend sa main ouvrière, ■ Une poignée de miette desséchées. ■
o ■ Hurlent à toutes les frontières ■ Et comme réponse ■ Bêtis
ux. ■ „Londres, ■ Banquet, ■ Présence du roi et de la reine ■ Qu
tout en or!“ ■ Soyez maudits! ■ Que ■ Pour votre tête couronnée
ages, ■ Que ■ Brûle sur le royaume ■ L'incendie des révoltes! ■
Que des princes héritiers, ■ Des princesses, ■ Le manger ■ Se pré
du Parlement, ■ Rapport sur la famine ■ Par Fridjof Nansen“. ■ On
si on écoutait ■ Un ténor ■ Dans une romance à la mode. ■ Soyez
s ■ La voix humaine! ■ Prolétariat français ■ Hé! ■ Prends dans u
Washington, ■ Les fermiers ayant bouffé, ■ Ayant bu, ■ Tellemnet
■ Dans la mer ■ Ils jettent le superflu ■ De la fine farine, ■
audits! ■ Que ■ Vos rues ■ Soient pleines de révoltes, ■ Que, trou
sur le Sud ■ De l'Amérique, ■ On joue de vos panses! ■ Comme d
■ Leurs bandes sont satisfaites, ■ Avec les affamés ■ Ils se battent
Le patriote russe. ■ Soyez maudits! ■ Dehors! ■ Eternellemenet! ■ D
par le son ■ De l'or français, ■ Soyez errants ■ Pour l'éternité! ■
ands arbres, ■ Que leur image ■ Toujours pendue, ■ Se balance t
se se plaint: ■ A l'Empire, ■ On fait des grimaces, ■ On y donne trent
audits! ■ Que cela soit ainsi: ■ Que chaque bouchée avalée ■ Voi
en ciseaux ■ Et vous coupe les intestins! ■ Seront morts ■ Vingt millions d'hommes. ■ Au nom de tous ceux
■ Malédiction aujourd'hui ■ Jusqu'a l'éternité ■ A ceux qui ont détourné ■ Leur gueule bouffie ■ Du Volga
e n'est pas ■ Pour la panse remplie ■ Ni pour le trône du Tsar! ■ Dans un tel coeur ■ Les mots ne peuvent r
Les touchent ■ Les lances des révolutions! ■ A vous ■ Petits atomes ■ D'une énorme armée, ■ Avec la force
■ On fera sauter le monde ■ Des milliardaires! ■ A vous! ■ A vous! ■ A vo

LISTEN, SCOUNDRELS!

CALLS TO ACTION FROM EARLY CAS.

e secours! ■ So
faut se rendre.
■ Avec une ve
e la terre. ■
r, ■ Pour ne p
Un peu de pa
ns les colonnes
it rentrer ■ Da
s sauvages ■ L
nt brûlées ■ To
armites! ■ „Par
un air de rossign
nité ■ Vous n'e
s, ■ Une foule
e ■ Pour soulev
■ Avec du maï
ensibles, ■ Sur
in, ■ Les émigr
stache, ■ Marc
tre air de Jud
vous, ■ Choisis
■ „Moscou, ■
us ■ Depuis 191
bifteck saignant

Listen, Scoundrels! is part of my PhD research into the application of AI in curatorial practice, specifically its potential for exploring archival materials. This project focuses on PAGE magazine, the newsletter of the Computer Arts Society, which has shaped discourse on art and technology since its founding in 1969.

For this exploration, I began by generating a number of reports and deep dives into the archive, each time the AI guided by the purpose thematic analysis, allowing it to independently identify recurring themes and important overarching narratives.

What emerged was a portrait of radical conversations, pioneering figures, and a deeply engaged and committed artistic community. The exhibition hopes to capture this critical spirit, encouraging viewers to draw connections between past artistic experimentation and contemporary challenges.

CURATORIAL PROCESS

AI-Generated Audio Summaries (Deep Dives)

- The AI generates multiple audio summaries based on initial data or thematic prompts.
- These summaries serve as the foundation for deeper analysis.
- The curator listens to these summaries to:
 - Identify and map recurring themes.
 - Take note of any outliers, such as unusual insights or unexpected data points.

Curatorial Decision Making

- After identifying key themes and anomalies, the curator documents essential questions or insights derived from the audio summaries.
- These questions help refine the focus of the next AI processing steps.

AI Text Analysis via RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation)

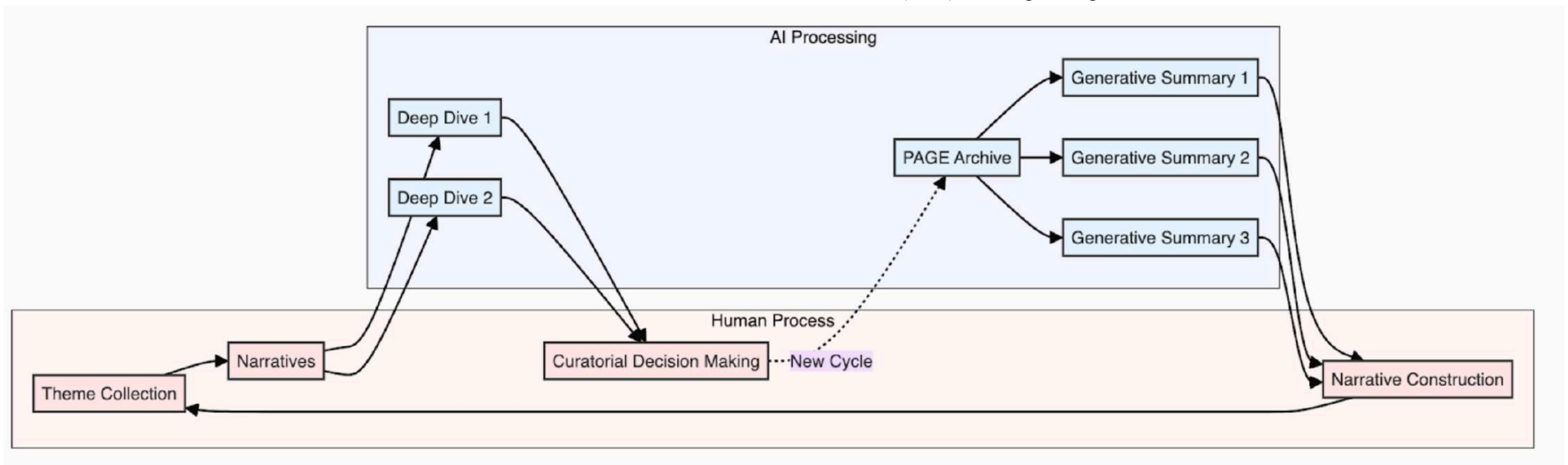
- The PAGE Archive—which contains AI-generated outputs like summaries—is analyzed using Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) within a Google Notebook Large Language Model (LLM).
- The AI extracts relevant text and queries it based on the curator's predefined questions.

Generative Summaries Creation

- Using the extracted text, the AI produces generative summaries that directly address the curator's inquiries.
- These summaries help in refining the conceptual and thematic framework of the project.

Narrative Construction

- The curator integrates insights from the generative summaries into a structured narrative.
- This stage involves the development of a curatorial direction, ensuring that the themes, data, and insights align with the broader artistic or research vision.



LISTEN, SCOUNDRELS ■ Pinned by these lines, ■ Stay
silent ■ Listen to these wolf howls ■ That barely
resemble A poem! ■ Give here ■ The biggest ■ The
baldest, ■ Grab them by the collar and shove them ■
Into the mud and the accounts ■ Of the Committees for
Aid to the Starving! ■ Look, ■ Do you see ■ Behind
these bare figures... ■ A gust of wind ■ Strong and
soft ■ Wraps in snow ■ Thousands ■ Of millions of
roofs, ■ The snow ■ Coffin of the villages of the
Volga. ■ The chimneys, ■ The candles. ■ Even the
crows ■ Disappear, ■ They sense ■ That, steaming,
■ Comes ■ Sweet and nauseating, ■ The scent ■ Of
the son, ■ The father, ■ The mother, ■ The
daughter ■ That they roast. ■ Whose turn is it? ■
There will be no help, ■ Separated by the snow, ■ No
help, ■ The air is empty! ■ No help! ■ Underfoot,
■ Even the mortar ■ They devour it! ■ Even the
weeds! ■ No, ■ No help, ■ Surrender, ■ For ten
provinces ■ Measure the graves. ■ Twenty million ■
Twenty, ■ Lie down, ■ Die! ■ But alone, ■ With a
hoarse voice, ■ With wild curses, ■ The snowy hair
of the roads ■ Pulled by the wind, ■ The earth sobs.

1. Reject Institutional Apathy

"Listen, scoundrels! Your fat
bellies are full, while the
world starves. Your
indifference is a crime, your
silence an act of violence."

— Vladimir Mayakovsky, Écoutez,
Canailles! [translated] PAGE 10

Mayakovsky's 1922 poem
"Écoutez, Canailles!"
("Listen, Scoundrels!")
rings with an urgent
command - its very title
demands attention. By
positioning this
confrontational work on
Page 10, followed
immediately by his essay
on military-industrial
computing on Page 11,
Metzger creates a powerful
dialogue across editions.

The poem's fierce critique of power
and institutional indifference takes
on new meaning in a context where many
artists of the period received
funding that could be traced back
to military, commercial and corporate
sources

Like these subtle
financial connections
that could be easily
overlooked, the poem's
untranslated French text
requires effort to
uncover.

Through this careful
sequencing, Metzger seems
to ask his readers: How
many other consequences
of institutional power do
we fail to see simply
because we don't take the
time to look?

COMPUTERS AND AUTOMATION

1. 3.4.1955; 4,17
2. 3.5.1954; 11
3. 3.5.1954; 22
4. 3.7.1954; 17
5. 4.3.1955; 28-9
6. 4.4.1955; 4
7. 4.5.1955; 14-20
8. 4.7.1955; 4
9. 4.8.1955; 6,9,16
10. 4.11.1955; 5
11. 5.8.1956; 4
12. 5.11.1956; 12-17
13. 5.12.1956; 16-19
14. 6.1.1957; 52-4
15. 6.2.1957; 14-19,43
16. 6.7.1957; 3
17. 6.7.1957; 6
18. 6.8.1957; 3,9
19. 6.11.1957; 6-8,14
20. 7.1.1958; 5-6
21. 7.2.1958; 3
22. 7.3.1958; 13-14
23. 7.4.1958; 6-9
24. 7.5.1958; 6,31
25. 7.5.1958; 22-29
26. 7.7.1958; 6
27. 7.8.1958 24
28. 7.9.1958 6,26,28
29 7.10.1958 9-10
30 7.10.1958 24-25
31. 7.10.1958 25
32. 7.12.1958 21-26
33. 7.12.1958 26-28
34. 8.1.1959 6-8
35. 8.2.1959 6-8
36. 8.2.1959 20-22
37. 8.3.1959 6,30-31
38. 8.4.1959 9,20
39. 8.4.1959 25-28
40. 8.5.1959 6,30
41. 8.5.1959 20-21
42. 8.9.1959 6,34-36
43. 8.10.1959 6,30
44. 8.10.1959 31
45. 8.12.1959 6
46. 9.4.1960 8-9
47. 10.5.1961 6-8,22
48. 10.7.1961 6,22
49. 10.8.1961 8.25.26
11. 5.8.1956; 4
12. 5.11.1956; 12-17
13. 5.12.1956; 16-19
14. 6.1.1957; 52-4
15. 6.2.1957; 14-19,43
16. 6.7.1957; 3
17. 6.7.1957; 6
18. 6.8.1957; 3,9
19. 6.11.1957; 6-8,14
20. 7.1.1958; 5-6
21. 7.2.1958; 3
22. 7.3.1958; 13-14

65. 16.11.1967 10-12
66. 17.3.1968 7,46,47
67. 17.4.1968 43-47
68. 17.7.1968 14
69. 17.8.1968 6,46
70. 17.8.1968 28
71. 17.9.1968 11
72. 17.12.1968 25-28
73. 18.4.1969 8,41
74. 18.4.1969 11-14
75. 18.5.1969 24-26
76. 18.6.1969 12-13
77. 18.8.1969 10-12
78. 18.8.1969 13-14
79. 18.9.1969 9
80. 18.10.1969 12-13
81. 18.10.1969 8
82. 18.11.1969 12-13,14
83. 19.2.1970 9-13
84. 19.5.1970 6-13
85. 19.5.1970 30-60
86. 19.6.1970 41-47
87. 19.6.1970 8-15
88. 19.7.1970 29-36

COMMUNICATIONS OF THE ACM

89. 1.2.1958 1
90. 2.7.1959 2
91. 3.7.1960 386,395
92. 3.7.1960 437
93. 4.5.1961 205
94. 4.5.1961 206
95. 4.6.1961 255
96. 4.10.1961 467-68
97. 4.10.1961 473
98. 4.12.1961 581
99. 5.1.1962 3
100. 5.1.1962 66
101. 5.6.1962 300-7
102. 5.6.1962 358
103. 5.7.1962 369
104. 5.7.1962 372
105. 5.10.1962 535-37
106. 6.1.1963 34
107. 6.1.1963 46
108. 6.7.1963 352
109. 6.7.1963 360
110. 6.10.1963 591
111. 7.1.1964 46
112. 7.1.1964 49
77. 18.8.1969 10-12
78. 18.8.1969 13-14
79. 18.9.1969 9
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83. 19.2.1970 9-13
84. 19.5.1970 6-13
85. 19.5.1970 30-60
86. 19.6.1970 41-47
87. 19.6.1970 8-15
88. 19.7.1970 29-36

128. 8.4.1965 248
129. 8.6.1965 409-10
130. 8.7.1965 420-21
131. 8.8.1965 532
132. 8.9.1965 583-84
133. 8.11.1965 651-55
134. 8.11.1965 656
135. 9.1.1966 53
136. 9.2.1966 125
137. 9.4.1966 310
138. 9.5.1966 390-91
139. 9.6.1966 465
140. 9.7.2966 473
141. 9.7.1966 474
142. 9.7.1966 539
143. 9.8.1966 545-56
144. 9.10.1966 714
145. 9.10.1966 719- 20
146. 9.10.1966 772
147. 9.10.1966 782
148. 9.11.1966 824-26
149. 9.12.1966 838-39
150. 9.12.1966 879-80
151. 10.1.1967 1,61
152. 10.1.1967 68
153. 10.1.1967 128-29
154. 10.3.1967 139-40
155. 10.3.1967 141-44
156. 10.3.1967 144
157. 10.3.1967 145-47
158. 10.4.1967 248
159. 10.4.1967 254
160. 10.5.1967 259
161. 10.5.1967 314-23
162. 10.5.1967 325
163. 10.5.1967 327-8
164. 10.6.1967 379-80
165. 10.6.1967 386
166. 10.6.1967 389
167. 10.7.1967 393,395
168. 10.7.1967 457
169. 10.8.1967 524
170. 10.8.1967 525
171. 10.3.1967 145-47
172. 10.9.1967 533-37
173. 10.10.1967 667-68
174. 10.10.1967 672
175. 11.1.1968 2
176. 11.1.1968 54
178. 11.1.1968 61
179. 11.1.1968 65
140. 9.7.2966 473
141. 9.7.1966 474
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144. 9.10.1966 714
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149. 9.12.1966 838-39
150. 9.12.1966 879-80
151. 10.1.1967 1,61

195. 11.7.1968 465-69
196. 11.7.1968 524
197. 11.7.1968 527-28
198. 11.7.1968 529
199. 11.8.1968 583
200. 11.8.1968 584
201. 11.9.1968 593
202. 11.9.1968 645-6
203. 11.9.1968 647
204. 11.9.1968 653-55
205. 11.9.1968 654
206. 11.10.1968 659
207. 11.10.1968 711
208. 11.10.1968 718
209. 11.11.1968 731,736
210. 11.11.1968 792
211. 11.12.1968 803-04
212. 11.12.1968 860
213. 11.12.1968 863
214. 11.12.1968 864-65
215. 11.12.1968 868
216. 11.12.1968 871
217. 12.2.1969 84
218. 12.2.1969 121
219. 12.2.1969 122-25
220. 12.3.1969 190
221. 12.4.1969 243
222. 12.5.1969 248
223. 12.5.1969 297
224. 12.5.1969 298
225. 12.6.1969 303
226. 12.8.1969 421
227. 12.8.1969 481
228. 12.9.1969 532-33
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231. 12.11.1969 594
232. 12.11.1969 641
233. 12.12.1969 706-07
234. 12.12.1969 709
235. 13.2.1970 126-7
236. 13.2.1970 128
237. 13.3.1970 140
238. 13.3.1970 195
239. 13.4.1970 203
240. 13.4.1970 205
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242. 13.4.1970 269
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244. 3.4.1970 271
245. 13.5.1970 272
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214. 11.12.1968 864-65
215. 11.12.1968 868
216. 11.12.1968 871
217. 12.2.1969 84
218. 12.2.1969 121

In PAGE 11, Metzger opens with a list of publications dating back to 1955 that highlight the expanding involvement with computers and the increasing support from both commercial and military sectors.

44. 8.10.1959 31
45. 8.12.1959 6
46. 9.4.1960 8-9
47. 10.5.1961 6-8,22
48. 10.7.1961 6,22
49. 10.8.1961 8.25.26
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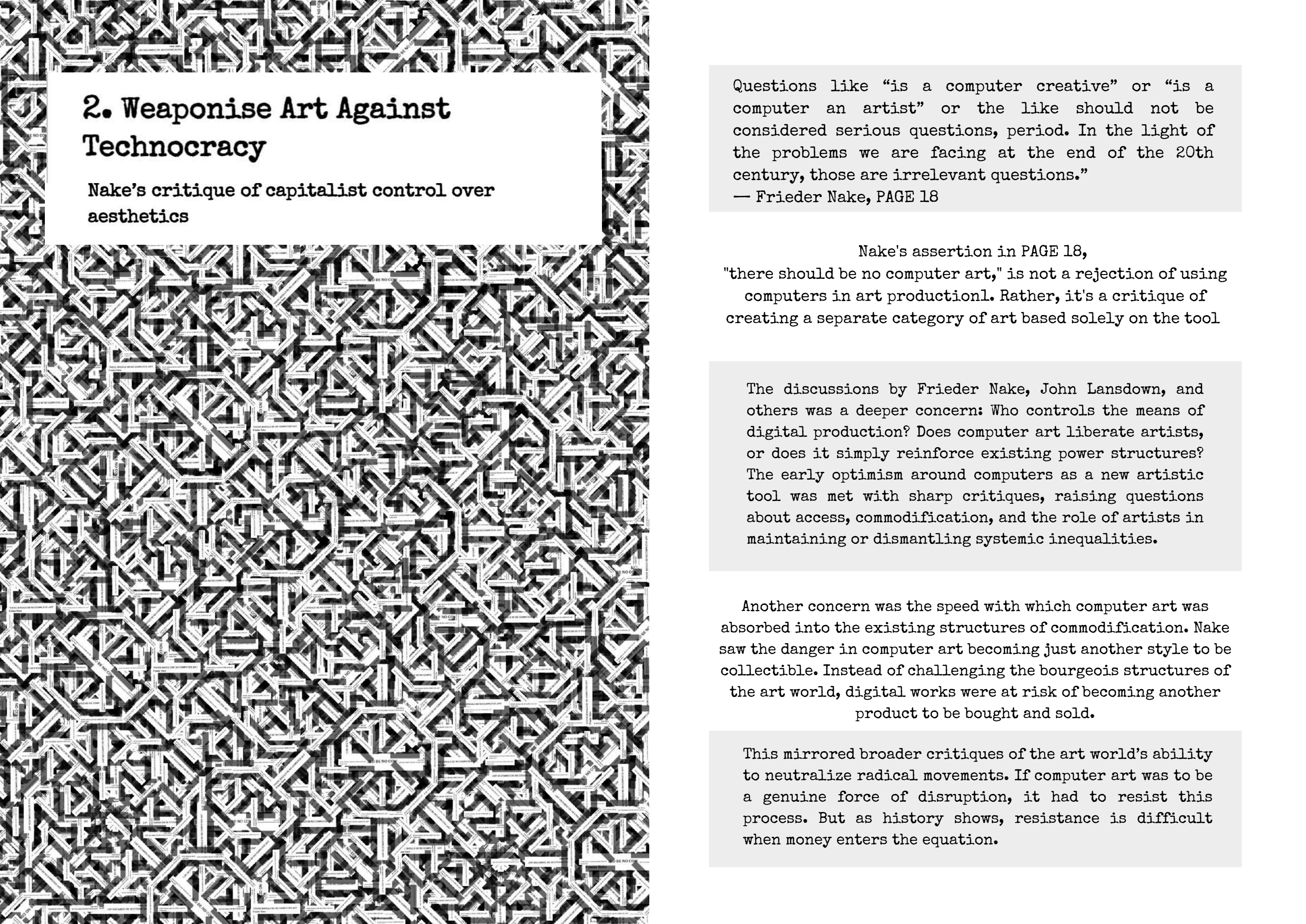
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174. 10.10.1967 672
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178. 11.1.1968 61
179. 11.1.1968 65
139. 13.3.1969 65, 144
156. 10.3.1967 144
157. 10.3.1967 145-47
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150. 9.12.1966 879-80
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232. 12.11.1969 641
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237. 13.3.1970 140
238. 13.3.1970 195
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232. 12.11.1969 641
233. 12.12.1969 706-07
234. 12.12.1969 709
235. 13.2.1970 126-7
236. 13.2.1970 128
237. 13.3.1970 140
238. 13.3.1970 195
239. 13.4.1970 203

ALL ARTISTS WILLING TO PROSTITUTE THEIR FUNCTIONS IN THIS WAY—
ALL ARTISTS WHO USE THE TITLE OF AVANT-GARDE TO HELP CONSERVE THE OLD ELITE—
ALL ARTISTS WHO REFUSE TO JOIN IN ATTACKING THE PRESENT SYSTEM—
ARE SHIT.

PAGE 11 - International Colaition for the Liquidation of Art



2. Weaponise Art Against Technocracy

Nake's critique of capitalist control over aesthetics

Questions like “is a computer creative” or “is a computer an artist” or the like should not be considered serious questions, period. In the light of the problems we are facing at the end of the 20th century, those are irrelevant questions.”
— Frieder Nake, PAGE 18

Nake's assertion in PAGE 18, “there should be no computer art,” is not a rejection of using computers in art production¹. Rather, it's a critique of creating a separate category of art based solely on the tool

The discussions by Frieder Nake, John Lansdown, and others was a deeper concern: Who controls the means of digital production? Does computer art liberate artists, or does it simply reinforce existing power structures? The early optimism around computers as a new artistic tool was met with sharp critiques, raising questions about access, commodification, and the role of artists in maintaining or dismantling systemic inequalities.

Another concern was the speed with which computer art was absorbed into the existing structures of commodification. Nake saw the danger in computer art becoming just another style to be collectible. Instead of challenging the bourgeois structures of the art world, digital works were at risk of becoming another product to be bought and sold.

This mirrored broader critiques of the art world's ability to neutralize radical movements. If computer art was to be a genuine force of disruption, it had to resist this process. But as history shows, resistance is difficult when money enters the equation.

For Nake, the answer wasn't to reject computers outright but to push them toward real critique. He suggested using computational tools to reveal systems of power, such as producing a film on wealth distribution. The challenge wasn't just to make art with computers but to use them against the structures that made their access so exclusive in the first place.

Even more critically, was the suggestion that computer programs were inherently designed for capitalist economies. The implication was that alternative systems were at a disadvantage because they had to adapt. If true, this wasn't just a critique of art, it was a critique of the deep ideological biases embedded in technological development.

Underlying these critiques was an unease about the role of technology itself. Was the computer an empowering tool, or was it a mechanism of control? Nake warned against what he called "sad technocratic Dadaism"—a superficial engagement with the machine that mistook novelty for revolution.

The discussions in PAGE were more than academic debates; they were warnings. Without critical engagement, computer art would become just another product of the establishment, a technological gloss on old hierarchies. The machine itself was neutral—but the way it was used, and who was allowed to use it, was anything but.

"The art market has reduced art to a series of fleeting fashions, driven by profit rather than genuine artistic merit. Art dealers determine what is valuable, and artists conform to their demands."

— PAGE 30

A letter in the Communications of the ACM Vol. 12 No. 5, May 1969 p. 248, protests against the dissolution of the ACM Special Interest Committee on Social Implications of Computing. The signators of the letter are organising a petition to reactivate the Committee. Offers of support should be addressed to Robert Bigelow 39 Grove Street Winchester Massachusetts 01800 USA Telephone 617-742-8300.

PAGE welcomes information about the fight by computer professionals against 1984.

Editorial - PAGE 3

3. Reclaim the Artist's Power Over Technology

Nash on the need to be lead by
artistic choices

Over
Na

[illegible]

1. The debate over technology's role in art, has long revolved around a core dichotomy: either creativity is an exclusively human trait, or "artificial creativity" is something we can build and develop to make art for us.

2. Nash challenges this binary, suggesting instead that artists need to lean into opportunities of technology and assert their artistic identity with it.

"Twenty years of a computerised society make it apparent that twenty years hence no artist can ignore the computer. He will have to adjust to it, cope with it, or use it. He cannot reject it."

— Katherine Nash - PAGE 07



PROCEDURE

Binary Space of Eight Dimensions

Generate a sequence of eight bits using a (pseudo) random process and obey the following procedure appropriately.

GOTO (Bond St x Oxford St)	OR (Main St x First Ave)	1
AT (Midnight)	OR (Midday)	2
ON (31 December)	OR (1 January)	3
WITH (A child)	OR (An animal)	4
WEARING (White)	OR (Black)	5
HOLDING (An umbrella)	OR (A balloon)	6
STAY (For an hour)	OR (For a minute)	7
AND (Sing a song)	OR (Speak to everyone)	8

One day I'll write a book called
PROCEDURAL ART: BEHAVIOURAL ART
and be famous
but I'm too busy just now
Alan Sutfcliffe

In Page 47 Vera Molnar opens her essay with two quotes presented in french. She begins:

"One of the best definitions of painting was given by the French Nabis painter Maurice Denis, who said:"

"Remember that a painting—before being a warhorse, a nude woman, or any kind of anecdote—is essentially a flat surface covered with colors assembled in a certain order." [translated]

"Some 600 years before him, Giovanni Boccaccio said almost the same thing in astonishingly modern terms: "

"...the painter strives for the depicted figure to emerge by itself, which is nothing other than a bit of color, skillfully applied to a panel..."
[translated]"

Vera Molnar, series: "10 Points", 1979. class: 9, interval: 3

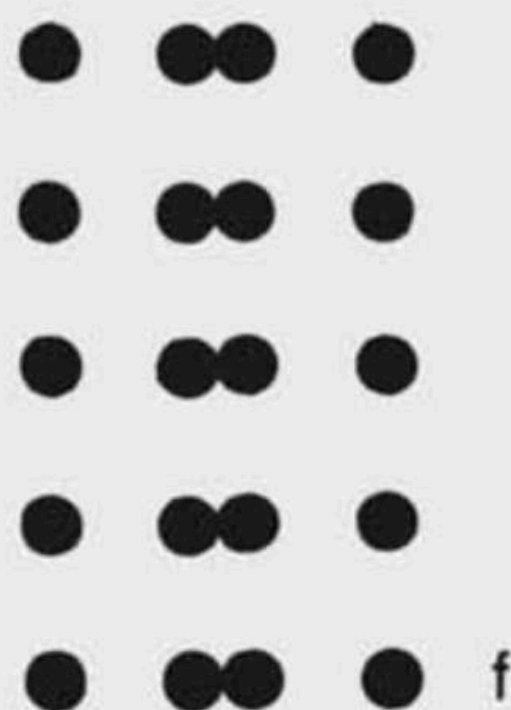
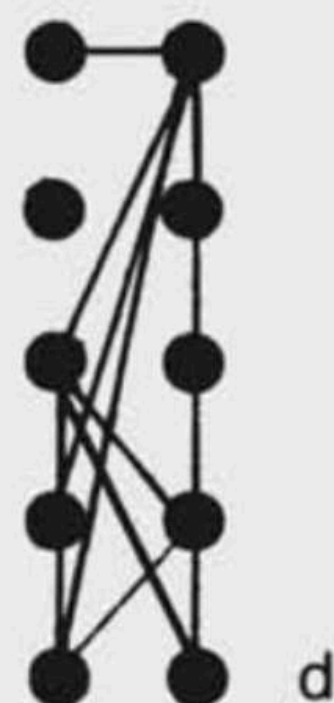
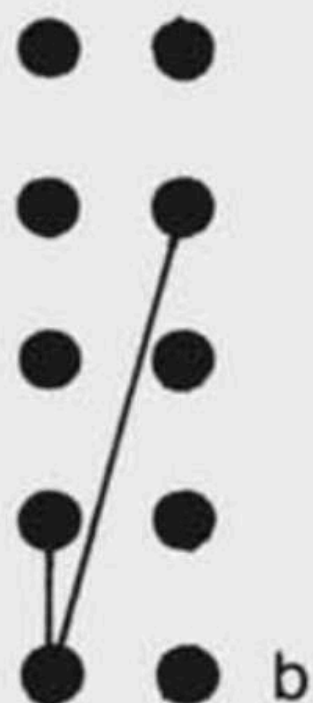
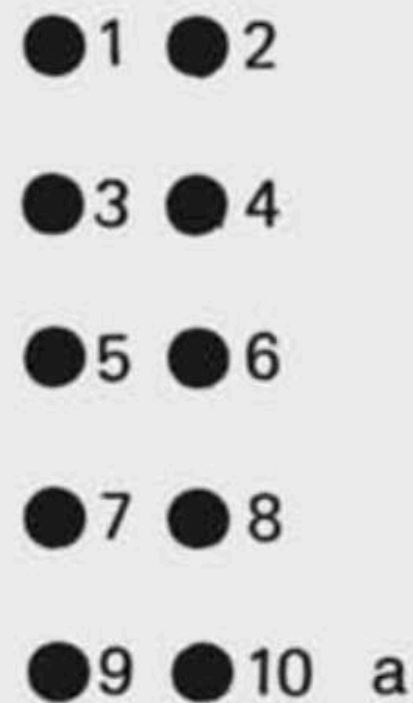
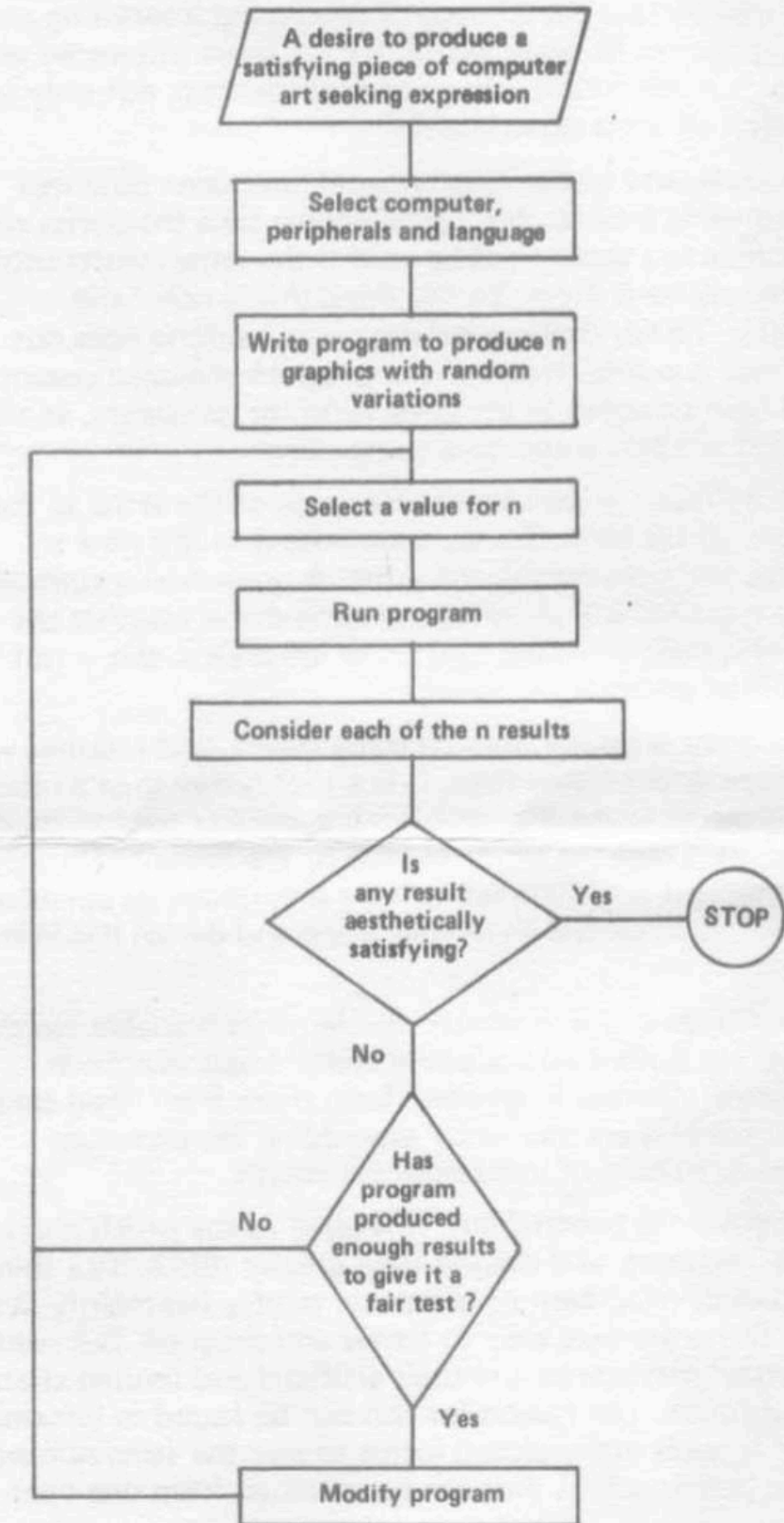


Figure 1

Molnar's essay presents a provocative rethinking of artistic creation, one that marries the traditional painter's challenge with the novel capabilities of computer-generated randomness. She begins by acknowledging that the painter's initial attempts to fill a surface often yield unsatisfactory results—a problem she addresses through systematic investigation. In her view, the computer becomes an ideal tool for exploring the vast realm of possible images, even though the sheer number of options makes it impossible for a human to examine every outcome.

Molnar's approach reflects a deliberate balance between order and chance. She does not embrace randomness for its own sake but integrates it as a research tool, using computational techniques to generate images within a controlled framework. This allows her to systematically explore visual possibilities while still making artistic decisions at every stage. By curating which randomly generated compositions to keep and which to discard, she remains the ultimate creative authority, reinforcing her belief that the artist is not replaced by technology but rather augmented by it.



FLOW CHART 2

4. BREAK FREE FROM THE ART MARKET SYSTEM

Artist Placement Group (APG):
APG injected artists into industry not for patronage but as agents of change. The core idea was to disrupt the traditional financial structures that controlled art forms by embedding artists within industrial settings. This approach aimed to create something interesting regardless of immediate financial payoff, challenging the purely monetary economy. APG sought to redefine the aims of society by linking artists and organizations, fearing the alienation of creative forces.

APG artists work in their firms as artists. Their presence is an affront to – if not an attack on – the normal product and profit premises of most companies. I am delighted to see them there, Like APG, the society has been concerned with establishing link: between artists and organisations, fearing the further alienation of the creative forces from those that drive society.

In the end perhaps we shall all be adapted and adopted by the political-military-academic-industrial-aesthetic complex.

Who will be the artists then?

Best wishes
+ Love to Barbara Alan

Art today is a **Monopoly** among many others

Art today is a **Monopoly** of creativity

Art today is a **Monopoly** of knowledge

Art Museums are the **Banks** of the art world

Art Auction Houses are the **Stock Exchange** of Art

Art Magazines are the **Ticker Tape**

Art Galleries are its **Show Rooms**

Art works are **Commodities**

Artists are creators of **Commodities**

While the INTERNATIONAL
COALITION FOR THE
LIQUIDATION OF ART make a
bold provocation to remind
artists what art is not, John
Whitney reminds us in PAGE 24
that neither the art market,
nor technical advancement is
really the goal.

"Who is the genius who will use
the computer for real great ART?

Not a trained artist—not a
programmer—but someone
(anyone) with extraordinary
imagination and a very human
sensitivity."

— John Whitney, PAGE 24

I find it very strange that, in this situation, outsiders from technology should begin to move into the world of art and try to save it with new methods of creation, old results, and by surrendering to the given "laws of the market" in a naive and ignorant manner. The fact that they use new methods makes them blind to notice that they actually perpetuate a situation which has become unbearable for many artists.

NAKE PAGE 18

"What should the radicalized computer person do? Leave the business? Convert the firm? Sabotage? Work for a hospital? Get stoned?".

Write to 36 St. Georges Avenue London N7 for details.

Gustav Metzger and Frieder Nake both articulate strong critiques of the commercialisation of art, though they approach the issue from different perspectives. Metzger's focus is on the art world's complicity in capitalist structures, while Nake is particularly concerned with how computer art risks becoming a commodity that reinforces existing power hierarchies. Both argue that art should resist rather than uphold these dominant systems.

For Metzger, the art world was deeply embedded in capitalist and corporate interests, shaping cultural values in ways that serve financial and political elites. His Executive Profile Exhibition (PAGE 26) examines how newspapers like The Times and Financial Times construct and reinforce an image of society dictated by the establishment, highlighting the role of media in upholding capitalist norms. His vision of a Negative Growth Society (PAGE 19) challenges not just the economic system but the very notion of art's role within it, advocating for an approach that resists market-driven imperatives rather than conforming to them.

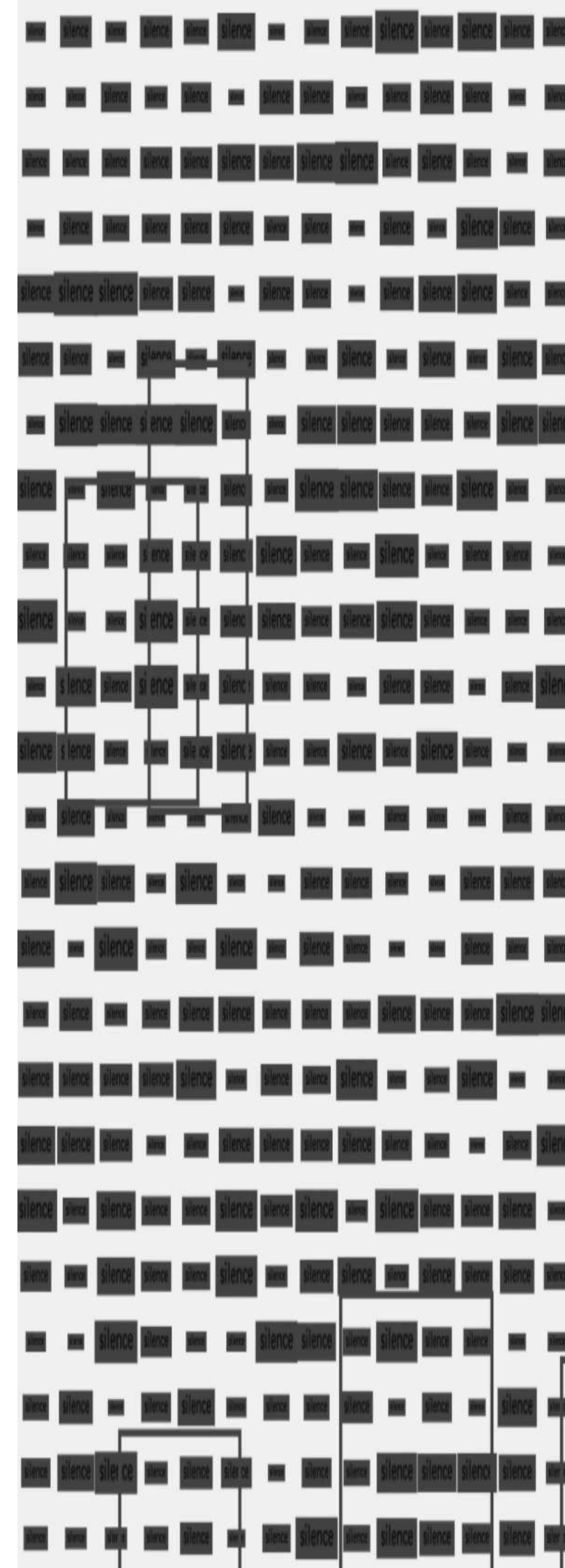
Despite their differing emphases, Metzger and Nake are united in their belief that art should be a means of critique, not submission. They reject the notion that art can remain politically neutral and instead insist that it must actively engage with and challenge the systems that shape it. Whether condemning corporate influence over the media or the commodification of digital art, both figures warn against the assimilation of art into structures of power.

5 Create Art That Intervenes in the World

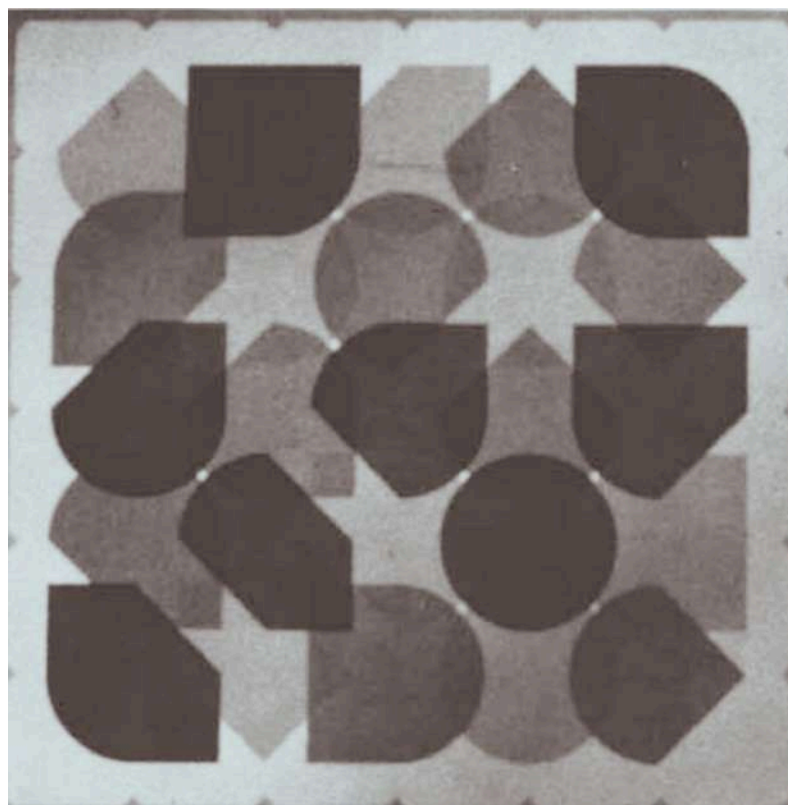
Paul Brown's critique of "socio-political art" as elite performance

*I am also concerned that many members of the arts establishment (in Britain at least) still find it hard - if even possible - to accept the computer as a tool or a medium for artists. They are not going to be convinced by **silence**.*

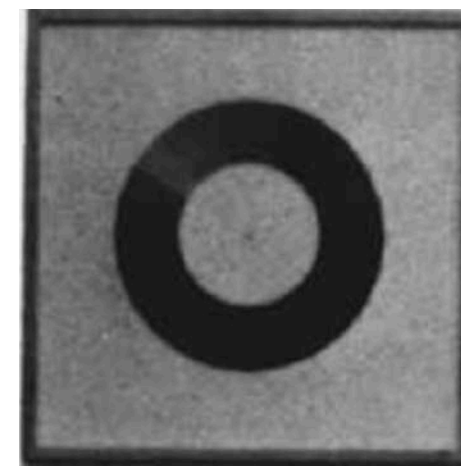
Paul Brown - Page 40



In PAGE 40 Paul Brown critiques the producing of work that caters only to an intellectual elite while at the same time cautioning of diluted efforts which risk prioritising engagement over artistic depth.



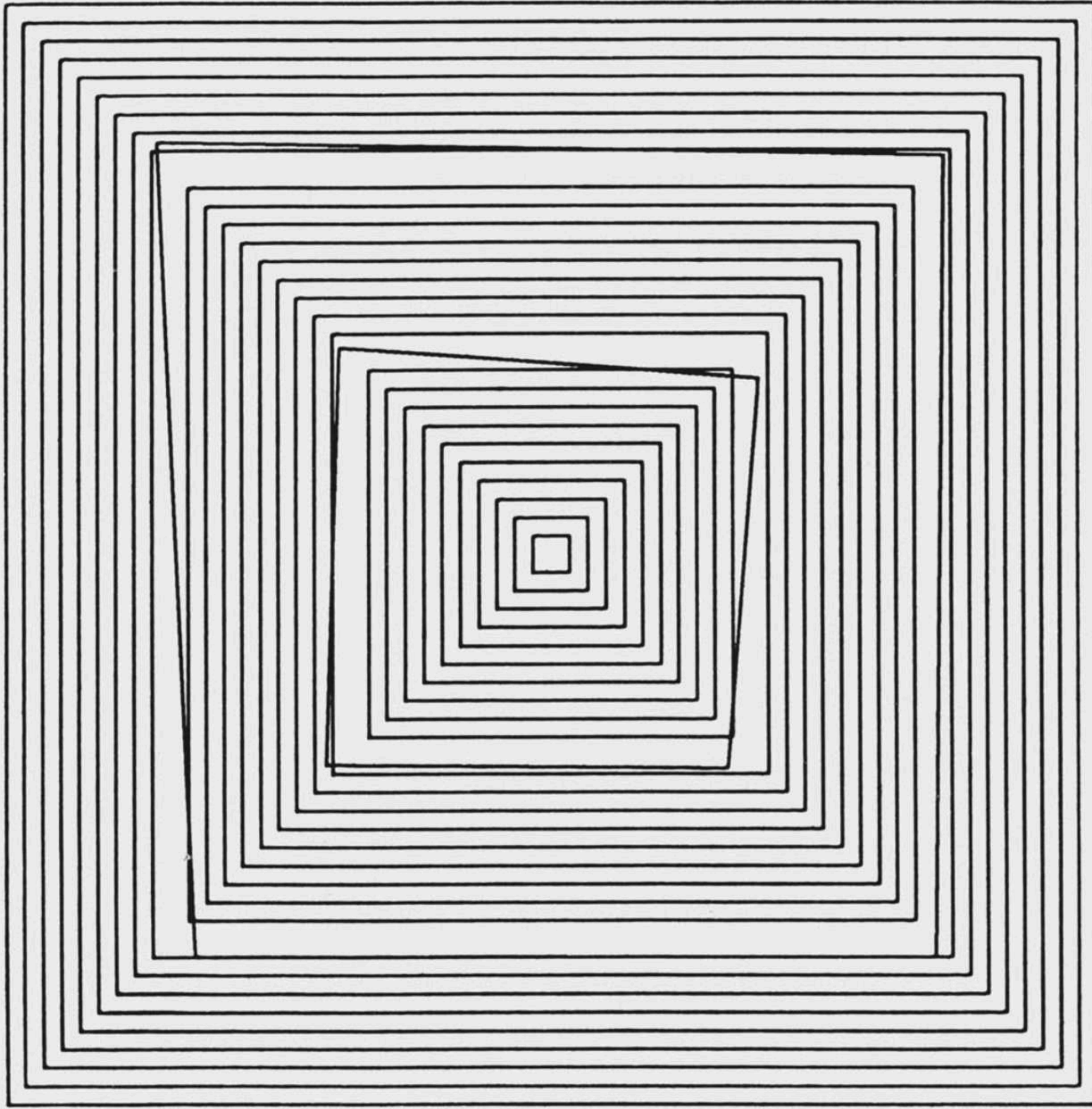
Paul Brown,
MODULUS (8) Series, 1978–79



Art that intervenes does not dictate meaning; it stimulates it. The refusal to engage critically with new technology in art is not just an aesthetic choice but a missed opportunity to participate in broader cultural narratives. To create art that intervenes in the world, then, is to engage with the moment, to actively shape that encounter. This means neither retreating into the purity of artistic isolation nor surrendering to populist simplicity.

VERA MOLNAR

“KUNST IST EIN FEHLER IM SYSTEM” (Art is a mistake in the system) said Paul Klee.



Guided by the AI's analysis, I was presented with a vast corpus of text. After refining this selection manually, I reintroduced it into another generative model, this time asking it to distil the material into distinct calls to action, extracting the essence of the discussions and debates that had shaped these dialogues.

Listen, Scoundrels! is/was a call to action, urging artists to critically engage with technology rather than become complicit in the systems of power and inertia that Mayakovsky and Metzger condemned. The phrase itself is drawn from Mayakovsky's 1922 poem *Écoutez, Canailles!* (Listen, Scoundrels!), a fierce denunciation of institutional apathy and a demand for artistic and political urgency.

SOURCES IN ORDER

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PAGE 3



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